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Edition: 5.30am
 Date: 04.09.2026
 Morning: 12.30pm
 Noon: 12.30pm
 Evening: 12.30pm
 Night: 12.30pm

Air quality (PM 10) at 7 pm
 Category: 94 ug/m³
 Status: 102 ug/m³
 Action: 10 ug/m³

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CHENNAI, Saturday, September 19, 2026 | Vol: 18, Issue: 351 | 12 pages

NEWS DIGEST

Amid dengue scare, Anna varsity student dies of scrub typhus

CHENNAI: Amid a dengue scare, a final-year student of Anna University, Harish Kumar, died of scrub typhus, a bacterial infection usually transmitted through the bite of infected mites. He was undergoing treatment at KMC hospital. Harish had reportedly been suffering from the infection for four days. He had initially consulted doctors at the university's campus hospital and was prescribed medication for fever. Meanwhile, another Anna University student has been admitted to Rajin Gandhi Government General Hospital after being diagnosed with dengue, while several other students at the hostel have also reportedly been suffering from fever.

Land acquisition to expand NLC mine-1

CHENNAI: The State government has issued a notification for the acquisition of around 5.64 hectares of land in Gangekondan village in Cuddalore district for the expansion of Mine-1 of the NLC (Oyeyveli Lignite Corporation) project. The notification has been issued under Section 3 (1) of the Tamil Nadu Acquisition of Land for Industrial Purposes Act. The government has also decided that the entire compensation payable for the acquired land should be met from the funds managed by NLC India Ltd.

Alternative sites along East Coast Road explored amid protests

Govt likely to back off from Pattinapakam Secretariat site

RAMAKRISHNA

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu government is set to drop Pattinapakam as the site for its proposed new Secretariat cum Assembly complex and is exploring alternative locations along the East Coast Road, amid mounting opposition from fishermen and political parties. The opposition over the proposal cut across party lines. The DMK, AIADMK, BJP, PMK, and allies of the ruling TVC, including left parties and VCK, questioned the choice of Pattinapakam, with demands ranging from shifting the project to another location to reconsidering the need for a new complex. The government had justified the proposal by citing space constraints at the existing Secretariat in Fort St George and the need for a modern integrated administrative complex. While sources said the government is in the final stages of preliminary and detailed designs, the choice of the coastal site in the heart of the city triggered sustained opposition from fishing communities, residents, and political parties. Fishermen from several coastal hamlets worried of intensified agitation if the government did not withdraw the proposal, citing concerns over their livelihood, access to the sea, and impact on fishing activities. The opposition over the proposal cut across party lines. The DMK, AIADMK, BJP, PMK, and allies of the ruling TVC, including left parties and VCK, questioned the choice of Pattinapakam, with demands ranging from shifting the project to another location to reconsidering the need for a new complex. The government had justified the proposal by citing space constraints at the existing Secretariat in Fort St George and the need for a modern integrated administrative complex. While sources said the government is in the final stages of preliminary and detailed designs, the choice of the coastal site in the heart of the city triggered sustained opposition from fishing communities, residents, and political parties. Fishermen from several coastal hamlets worried of intensified agitation if the government did not withdraw the proposal, citing concerns over their livelihood, access to the sea, and impact on fishing activities.

IN MAKING

SEPT 3: CM Vijay announces Rs 1,200-crore Secretariat-cum-Assembly complex

SEPT 8: Govt identifies 25.56 acres at Pattinapakam as the proposed site

SEPT 11: Opposition grows, with parties demanding that the site be reconsidered

SEPT 15: Fishermen from over 10 hamlets protest, set Sept 21 deadline to drop plan

SEPT 18: Govt sources indicate a rethink, alternative sites along ECR explored

LAND OURS, HAVE PROOF: FISHERS

CHENNAI: Local fishermen are contesting the Tamil Nadu government's claim to 25.56 acres of land in Pattinapakam earmarked for a Rs 1,200 crore Assembly-Secretariat complex. While the government states the land belongs to housing and state bodies, the community asserts it is ancestral property originally acquired from them in 1956-57, and is gathering historical documents to prove ownership.

TN explores KMUT template for Annapoorni scheme rollout

K BALASUBRAMANIAN

CHENNAI: The Tamil Nadu government is exploring the rules and guidelines of the Kalaignar Magalir Utham Thirai (KMUT) scheme to implement the Annapoorni Super Six (ASS) scheme, which was announced by every year under a reimbursement model. "The department is preparing the Government Order to implement the scheme. The government is exploring the rules and guidelines of the KMUT scheme, which seem to be similar to those of the Annapoorni Super Six scheme," an official's bank accounts. Around 1.38 crore families are expected to benefit from the scheme. The government will allocate Rs 4,000 crore for the scheme," the official added. Targeting 1.21 crore women across the State, the DMK government had implemented the KMUT scheme under which Rs

CM to launch 'Thai Maman' on Sept 28

CHENNAI: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay will launch the 'Thai Maman' (Thangam) Mothirasi scheme on September 28, under which a one-gram gold ring will be given to children born in government hospitals, the state government announced on Friday.

Keyword match: "dengue"

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TRANSLATED HEADLINE (English)

'Amid dengue scare, = eas

Full Article Text (English)

We are likely to back off from ae ace by the Govt

Nursing worker locks ward in toilet, flees with chain, phone

CHENNAI: A nursing worker who was hired to take care of an elderly woman, locked her in a toilet and fled with a chain, phone and a mobile phone, police said.

The woman was identified as Mrs. (name withheld) and was 65 years old. She was admitted to the ward on June 10. The nursing worker was identified as Mrs. (name withheld) and was 35 years old. She was arrested on June 11.

The police said the woman was found in the toilet on June 11. She was found with a chain and a mobile phone. The police said the woman was found in the toilet on June 11. She was found with a chain and a mobile phone.

PIPELINE WORK IN SHOLINGANALLUR

CHENNAI: The Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply Corporation (CMWS) has announced that supply will be affected from June 20 to June 21 in the Sholinganallur area. The work is for the installation of a new drinking water pipeline in the Sholinganallur area.

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No Metro Water supply for 10 days from tomorrow in zones 13, 14

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Saaveetha University opens digital media studio in city

CHENNAI: Saaveetha University has inaugurated a digital media studio in the city. The studio is for the production of digital media content. The studio is for the production of digital media content.

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Three-student team from IIT-M wins int'l competition held in Norway

CHENNAI: A team of three students from the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M) has won an international competition held in Norway. The team was awarded the first prize for their project on the design of a new type of solar cell.

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MTC driver dies in bikes' collision

CHENNAI: A 35-year-old MTC driver died in a collision with a motorcycle on the Madhavaram Road in Chennai. The driver was riding a motorcycle when he was hit by a truck. The driver was killed on the spot.

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3-member gang breaks into shops along OMR, escapes with loot

CHENNAI: A three-member gang broke into shops along the Outer Ring Road (OMR) in Chennai and escaped with a large amount of loot. The gang was seen running away from the scene of the crime.

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Auto driver dies after falling into open sewage pit

CHENNAI: A 32-year-old auto driver died after falling into an open sewage pit on the Anna Nagar Road in Chennai. The driver was riding an auto when he fell into the pit. The driver was killed on the spot.

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